

Zakira Farheen

Senior DevOps · SRE · DevSecOps · MLOps Engineer

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SUMMARY

Senior DevOps, SRE, and DevSecOps engineer with 15+ years building cloud-native infrastructure, automating delivery, and taking machine-learning models from research into production. Deep experience in regulated financial services (Aviva, Lloyds Bank): CI/CD, SLOs and error budgets, incident response, and shift-left security (SAST, container scanning, secrets management, policy-as-code). On the ML side, end-to-end pipelines with MLflow, Kubeflow, and AWS SageMaker, now focused on LLM, RAG, and agentic systems built to be secure and auditable, not just functional.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud: AWS, Azure, GCP

Infrastructure as code: Terraform, policy-as-code

CI/CD: Jenkins, Azure DevOps

Containers: Docker, Kubernetes

Practices: Chaos engineering, observability, monitoring & alerting

MLOps: MLflow, Kubeflow, SageMaker, Weights & Biases

DevSecOps: SAST, container scanning, secrets management

Reliability/SRE: SLOs, error budgets, incident response, RCA

Generative AI: LLMs, RAG, LangGraph

Domains: Financial services, regulated/compliance environments

EXPERIENCE

Senior DevOps Engineer

Jan 2024 – Present

Aviva Canada (via Tata Consultancy Services) · Toronto, ON

- Run DevOps for the Guidewire application suite on AWS with Terraform, with a focus on reliability, automation, and incident response.
- Maintain CI/CD pipelines and the monitoring and alerting that catches production issues before they become outages.
- Lead troubleshooting, root-cause analysis, and production error detection to minimize downtime for dependent teams.

Lead DevOps / Cloud Consultant

May 2021 – Jan 2024

Aviva UK (via Tata Consultancy Services) · United Kingdom

- Led the DevOps and cloud transformation for Aviva UK, designing end-to-end deployment pipelines and replacing manual processes with fully automated builds and releases.
- Owned infrastructure provisioning on Azure with Terraform; drove CI/CD discipline through Jenkins and Azure DevOps.
- Ran cross-cloud workloads on AWS and partnered with development teams to raise pipeline quality and delivery confidence.

Senior DevOps Engineer

Jan 2019 – May 2021

Lloyds Bank, UK (via Tata Consultancy Services)

- Modernised the CI/CD pipeline for a suite of .NET applications at one of the UK's largest banks, rebuilding delivery on AWS and GCP with full automation.
- Balanced delivery speed with strict security, compliance, and audit requirements, improving release frequency and team confidence.

Senior DevOps Engineer

Apr 2017 – Jan 2019

Lloyds Bank, UK (via Teamware Solutions, Quantum Leap Consulting)

- Built CI/CD pipelines for .NET applications and migrated workloads to AWS and GCP.
- Reduced manual deployment steps and improved pipeline reliability within strict change-management and audit controls.

Technology Analyst

Aug 2010 – Aug 2015

Nordstrom, US (via Infosys)

- Release engineering and build management for a large retail environment: artifact versioning, build management, and deployments to on-premise infrastructure.
- Built a foundation in the full path from a developer's commit to production, which underpins later automation work.

Research Fellow

Sep 2008 – Aug 2010

Osmania University

- Applied research in structured data analysis on large datasets; first step into machine learning that informs current production-ML work.

EDUCATION

M.Eng, Embedded Systems & VLSI Design

Osmania University · 2008 – 2010

B.Tech, Electronics & Communication Engineering

Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University · 2004 – 2008

CERTIFICATIONS

- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
- Microsoft Certified: DevOps Engineer (AZ-400)
- Professional Scrum Master I
- IBM Certified Solution Advisor — Cloud Computing Architecture V5

PUBLICATION

Content-Based Image Retrieval using Independent Component Analysis.

References available on request. · crlab.ca/MLOps